Digital Literacy Project Report

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Name: Kartik Tiwari
Registration Number: 25BCE10581
Branch: B.Tech CSE Core
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Introduction

In today's world, digital technology plays a central role in education, communication, and career development. As students, we use various online tools daily, but responsible and effective use requires digital literacy. This project was designed to help us understand how to build a professional digital presence, communicate appropriately online, collaborate using digital platforms, and stay safe from cyber threats.

As a Student Digital Ambassador, my task was to create resources and examples that could guide my peers in navigating the digital environment responsibly. The project involved five modules, each focusing on a different aspect of digital literacy — awareness, portfolio building, collaboration tools, communication etiquette, and cybersecurity. Through this project, I not only developed practical skills but also became more conscious of my digital behavior and online footprint.

Task 1 Infographic

For this task, I used **Canva** to create a one-page infographic on Digital Literacy Awareness. Canva was chosen because of its user-friendly interface, wide variety of templates, and availability of icons and design elements that help present information visually. My infographic covered three major topics: what digital literacy means, safe internet practices, and maintaining a professional online presence.

The design explains digital literacy as more than just knowing how to use devices; it includes understanding online risks, responsible communication, and ethical behavior. I included tips such as using strong passwords, verifying information before sharing, and maintaining respectful communication online. Visual icons and color coding were used to make the content easy to understand at a glance.

One challenge I faced was selecting only the most important information while keeping the design uncluttered. It was interesting to see how visual presentation can influence how seriously people engage with information. This task helped me realize that digital awareness resources must be both informative and visually appealing to be effective.

Task 2 Digital Portfolio

In this task, I created or updated profiles on **GitHub, LinkedIn, and HackerRank** to establish a basic professional digital presence. GitHub is used to showcase coding projects and technical work, LinkedIn serves as a professional networking platform, and HackerRank helps demonstrate problem-solving skills through coding challenges.

On GitHub, I created a profile README including my name, branch, academic year, and my goal of developing strong programming skills during my B.Tech. On LinkedIn, I completed my education details, including my current degree and institution. These platforms together form a foundation for future internships and career opportunities.

Over the next four years, I plan to upload coding projects to GitHub, connect with professionals and alumni on LinkedIn, and regularly practice problems on HackerRank to improve my technical skills. Building these profiles early allows gradual growth rather than creating everything at the last minute before placements. This task showed me that a professional digital identity is built over time through consistent effort.

Task 3 Platforms

For this task, I explored both a coding practice platform and a collaboration tool. I created an account on **HackerRank** and completed a beginner-level challenge. This platform helps students improve logical thinking and programming skills through structured problems and immediate feedback. Solving even a basic challenge gave me confidence and introduced me to the format used in technical assessments.

For collaboration, I created a **Google Form** as a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz for my batchmates. The form included five questions with different formats such as multiple-choice and short-answer responses. I also reviewed the automatically generated Google Sheet containing responses, which demonstrates how data collection and analysis can be done efficiently.

These tools will be useful academically because coding platforms help prepare for technical exams and placements, while collaboration tools enable surveys, feedback collection, and group work management. This task highlighted how digital platforms can support both individual learning and collective activities.

Task 4 Communication Scenario

Poor digital communication can create misunderstandings and damage professional relationships. One common situation is when a student sends an informal or incomplete email to a professor requesting an extension. Without a proper subject line, respectful tone, or explanation, the request may appear careless or disrespectful, reducing the likelihood of approval.

A better approach would be to write a clear subject line, address the professor formally, explain the reason briefly, and express gratitude for their consideration. Professional communication demonstrates responsibility and respect for the recipient's time.

This task reinforced the importance of adapting communication style according to context. While informal messaging is acceptable among friends, academic and professional interactions require structure and courtesy. Developing this habit early can positively influence future opportunities.

Task 5 Cybercrime Reflection

While researching cybercrime, I was most surprised by how common online fraud has become and how easily ordinary users can become targets. Phishing scams and UPI fraud often rely on psychological manipulation rather than technical complexity. Attackers create urgency or impersonate trusted entities to trick victims into sharing sensitive information.

This research made me realize that awareness alone is not enough; cautious behavior is equally important. As a result, one habit I plan to change is verifying any unexpected message or link before responding, especially those related to financial transactions or account details.

Understanding cyber threats is essential for students because digital services are deeply integrated into daily life. Taking simple precautions can prevent serious consequences such as financial loss or identity theft.

Conclusion

This project provided a comprehensive understanding of digital literacy beyond basic technical skills. It demonstrated how professional identity, communication, collaboration, and cybersecurity are interconnected in the digital world. By completing these tasks, I developed practical experience in building online profiles, using learning platforms, creating awareness resources, and practicing responsible digital behavior.

As a Student Digital Ambassador, I now feel better prepared to guide my peers in using technology safely and effectively. The project emphasized that digital literacy is an ongoing process that requires awareness, critical thinking, and continuous improvement.

References

- Canva — https://www.canva.com
- GitHub — https://github.com
- LinkedIn — https://www.linkedin.com
- HackerRank — https://www.hackerrank.com
- Google Forms — https://forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Portal — https://cybercrime.gov.in